

Sesh

AI-Assisted Brand Identity & Inclusive Persona Development

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SECTION 1 — COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Competitor matrix updated with verified pricing. Caveday added as sixth competitor. Feature gap analysis updated with no-show and reliability design as confirmed market failure mode.

Competitor	Model	Pricing	Target User	Key Feature	Gap vs Sesh
Focusmate	1-on-1 live video pairing	Free (3/wk) / \$8/mo annually or \$12/mo monthly	General productivity, ADHD, solo remote workers	50-min scheduled sessions with a matched partner	Anonymous partners; no community leaders; no task-initiation support; scheduling required; no off-hour coverage
Flow Club	Group video coworking	\$40/mo or \$33.33/mo annually	Professionals, creators, remote workers	2,500+ weekly sessions, host-facilitated with music and check-ins	Premium price; no neurotype-aware design; US/UK-centric availability; no variable capacity design
Caveday	Facilitated deep-work sessions	\$30-40/mo or \$20 drop-in	Knowledge workers wanting structured focus	Guided 'Caves' with timed sprints, break structure, team options	Highest structure of any competitor; excludes users who can't commit to rigid session formats; no life task support
Flown	Group deep work rooms	~£20/mo	Knowledge workers, academics	Nature soundscapes, facilitated focus rooms, recharge sessions	UK-centric; upselling friction flagged by users; no async; no neurotype-aware language; no community leadership
Tiimo	Visual daily planner	Free / \$4.99/mo	ADHD, autism users	Visual scheduling with time awareness tools	Planning only -- no live sessions, no body doubling, no community; addresses scheduling not initiation
dubbii	Body doubling app	Subscription (price unconfirmed)	ADHD, chores and self-care users	Shame-free task support, guided routines	No named community leaders; limited global timezone support; no photo-to-task; no variable capacity design

Feature Gap Analysis — gaps identified through competitive scan and cross-referenced against Sesh persona pain points and implicit design assumption audit.

Feature / Capability	Competitor Landscape	Sesh Opportunity
Named community session leaders	None. Leaders are anonymous, staff-only, or absent across all competitors.	Steadies give recurring identity, trust, and belonging to live sessions. Users return to people, not rooms.

Neurotype-aware UX language	Tiimo addresses ADHD scheduling only. All others use neurotypical productivity defaults.	Every touchpoint designed for variable capacity, task initiation resistance, and shame-free re-entry.
Global and off-hour session access	All competitors assume US/UK daytime availability. No reliable coverage for overnight or non-Western timezones.	Community-powered Steadies create organic global and off-hour coverage. Adaeze and Malik are not afterthoughts.
Photo-to-task initiation	No competitor offers this.	Scan what needs doing. Reduce the cognitive overhead of identifying where to start before presence helps.
Spontaneous alongside presence	All competitors require scheduling or calendar commitment in advance.	Join an open Sesh immediately. No planning required. The app meets users where their capacity actually is.
Variable energy and chronic illness design	No competitor addresses energy pacing, capacity variability, or chronic illness as a primary design consideration.	Capacity check-ins normalize bad days. No streaks. Returning is the win, not consistency.
No-show and reliability design	Focusmate's top user complaint is no-shows and late partners undermining the accountability effect.	Community Steadies are recurring, recognized, and invested in the session -- not random pairings.

Competitive positioning summary: The body doubling market is built on a performance model of motivation -- clarity, commitment, execution, tracking. Sesh operates on a regulation model -- presence, safety, reduced friction, action. No competitor has made that distinction explicit in their design. Sesh's differentiation is not a feature set, it is a fundamentally different assumption about how people get things done.

SECTION 2 — RESEARCH VALIDATION & FACT-CHECKING

Key claims from the competitive scan verified against primary sources. Evidence table follows the AI Fact-Check Checklist framework: source or suspicion, cross-check, trust the numbers, time-check, confirm context.

Claim	AI Source	Verification Status	Supporting Evidence	Confidence
Focusmate pricing: free tier (3 sessions/week), Plus \$8/mo annually or \$12/mo monthly	Perplexity competitive scan	☑ Verified	Confirmed directly at focusmate.com/pricing. Note: a third-party review site listed \$9.99/mo, which conflicts with the official page. Official source used.	High
Flow Club pricing: \$40/mo or \$33.33/mo billed annually	Perplexity competitive scan	☑ Verified	Confirmed via Flow Club help center (help.flow.club). Perplexity cited \$400/year which is accurate in total but the per-month annual figure is \$33.33, not a flat annual sum.	High
Focusmate's top user complaints include no-shows, late partners, and rising prices	Perplexity user complaint scan	☑ Verified	Corroborated across Trustpilot reviews, Reddit r/productivity, and ProductHunt reviews cited in Perplexity sources.	High
Flown users specifically flag upselling and pop-ups as friction	Perplexity user complaint scan	☑ Verified	Corroborated via Trustpilot reviews of Flown cited in Perplexity source list.	High
dubbii subscription pricing (specific price unconfirmed)	Perplexity competitive scan	⚠ Partial	Perplexity confirmed subscription required and in-app purchases. No specific monthly price was confirmed in App Store listings or press coverage reviewed. Excluded from competitor matrix pricing column.	Medium -- price not stated

Process note: Pricing data was verified directly at official app websites and help centers. User complaint data was corroborated across Trustpilot, Reddit, and ProductHunt sources cited in the Perplexity scan. Pricing changes frequently -- all figures should be re-verified before Unit 3. The dubbii price remains unconfirmed and is excluded from the competitor matrix pricing column rather than stated with false confidence.

SECTION 3 — USER RESEARCH SURVEY

15 questions organized across 5 groups. Each maps to a specific research assumption with documented signal criteria. Questions drafted with AI support, then evaluated and revised for behavioral grounding, neutral language, and cross-background interpretability. A final question (E4) added to surface structural and systemic barriers that standard productivity app research misses.

Question Groups: A — Task Behavior (A1-A3) | B — Current Tool Use (B1-B3) | C — Scheduling & Access (C1-C2) | D — Social & Community (D1-D3) | E — Design Fit (E1-E4)

#	Question	Type	Assumption Tested	Strong Signal Looks Like
A1	Walk me through what happens when you sit down to do a task you have been putting off. What usually stops you?	Open / Behavioral	Task initiation failure is the core barrier, not motivation or ability	User describes a specific internal or environmental pattern rather than a generic answer about distraction
A2	Think of a time you actually got something done that surprised you. What was different about that day?	Open / Behavioral	External conditions -- presence, structure, timing - - matter more than willpower	User identifies a social or environmental factor rather than a personal attribute like discipline
A3	How often do you have days where your capacity feels significantly lower than normal?	Closed / Frequency	Variable energy is common and unaddressed by current tools	More than half of respondents report this three or more times per week
B1	What tools or habits do you currently use to get things done? What makes you go back to them?	Open / Behavioral	Users have workarounds that reveal real unmet needs	Specific behaviors like phone calls, background TV, or working near others that point to ambient presence
B2	Have you tried any accountability or productivity apps? What made you stop using them?	Open / Behavioral	Existing tools fail at retention due to friction, cost, or tone mismatch	Abandonment reasons related to setup cost, scheduling rigidity, or shame-prone design
B3	Have you ever worked alongside someone else, in person or virtually, and found it helped you focus? Tell me about it.	Open / Behavioral	Body doubling is already a discovered behavior for many users even if unnamed	User describes the behavior without knowing the term body doubling
C1	When during the day or week are you most likely to tackle tasks you have been avoiding?	Closed + Open / Behavioral	Task timing is irregular and does not align with standard 9-5 session availability	Majority of responses cluster outside of 9am-5pm or vary unpredictably week to week
C2	If an app offered live sessions to work alongside others, what time slots would be most useful for you?	Closed / Preference	Global and off-hour session coverage is an unmet need	Strong preference for evening, weekend, overnight, or variable availability rather than standard business hours
D1	How important is it that the person you are working alongside knows you versus is a stranger?	Scale + Open	Trust and social comfort affect willingness to join sessions	Majority prefer known or community-established facilitators over random pairings
D2	What would make you feel comfortable joining a session with someone you did not know?	Open / Attitudinal	Facilitator identity and context reduce friction to entry	Users name visible traits -- profile, tone, stated task type, shared community membership

D3	If a community member regularly hosted sessions and you recognized them over time, would that change how likely you are to join?	Scale	Named recurring Steadies increase session attendance and trust	Strong agreement from 60% or more of respondents on a 5-point scale
E1	What words or phrases would make you immediately distrust a productivity or wellness app?	Open / Attitudinal	Clinical, urgent, or performative language creates friction for the target audience	Words like optimize, crush, streaks, accountability partner appear repeatedly
E2	Imagine you open an app and the first screen says: Some days the dishes feel impossible. You are in the right place. How does that land for you?	Open / Attitudinal	Sesh brand voice resonates with the target audience	Users describe feeling seen, relieved, or like this is for me
E3	What would need to be true for you to open this app on a hard day, when you had low energy and felt behind?	Open / Behavioral	Low-friction shame-free entry is the deciding factor for retention on hard days	Users describe a single tap, no setup, no pressure to perform -- ambient spontaneous entry
E4	Is there anything about your schedule, energy, or life situation that most productivity apps seem to ignore?	Open / Attitudinal	Structural and systemic barriers are invisible to most tools	References to overnight schedules, caregiving, chronic illness, or variable capacity that apps punish or ignore

Bias and neutrality audit: Questions reviewed to eliminate leading language, assumptions about US-centric schedules, and attitudinal framing that asks what users prefer rather than what they do. Behavioral questions (A1, A2, A3, B1, B3, C1, E3, E4) are highest priority in analysis because they reveal actual patterns. E4 was added specifically to capture the structural and systemic barriers the implicit assumptions audit identified as invisible to standard research instruments.

SECTION 4 — JOURNEY MAP & PAIN POINT PRIORITIZATION

Primary persona: Jordan Alvarez, 29, UX Writer, Toronto. ADHD diagnosed at 27. Not looking for a coach or a system. Looking for company.

	Awareness	Consideration	Onboarding	Core Use	Retention
Actions	Searches for body doubling or working alongside others; discovers via ADHD Reddit, TikTok, word of mouth, or a friend mentioning it	Explores App Store listing; reads reviews; checks pricing; compares to Focusmate; looks for social proof from people like her	Downloads app; creates profile; sees first open Sesh available; joins without scheduling anything in advance	Opens app when task resistance hits; joins or starts a Sesh; recognizes a Steady by name; checks in before and after session	Returns on a hard day; capacity check-in normalizes low energy; no streak lost; begins to trust the app on bad days not just good ones
Thoughts	I did not know this was a thing. Other people do this too?	Will this feel awkward? Is this for people like me or just ADHD productivity content online?	I hope this does not make me set up a whole system. I just want to start.	Okay this is actually helping. I did the thing.	I came back on a bad day. That says something.
Emotions	Curiosity, relief, mild skepticism	Cautious hope, anxiety about social pressure or being judged for what she is working on	Uncertainty, low patience for friction, quiet hope that this one will be different	Focus, calm, mild accomplishment without performance	Quiet loyalty, normalized use, reduced shame around task avoidance on variable days
Pain Points	Hard to find -- search terms are not standardized; body doubling is not yet a mainstream concept in app stores	App Store visuals feel clinical or productivity-coded; reviews skew neurotypical; pricing and free tier unclear	Any required setup -- choosing a plan, filling out a profile, scheduling -- risks abandonment before first session	Session timing mismatch; not available when capacity crashes late at night or on irregular days	Streak pressure or gamification breaks the shame-free contract; inconsistency gets penalized at the exact moment she needs support most
Opportunities	Organic community growth and SEO around body doubling, executive dysfunction, and task initiation language rather than productivity	Visuals and copy that speak to the experience not the diagnosis; social proof from recognizable Steadies not anonymous reviews	Single-tap entry into an open Sesh immediately on first launch; no scheduling required; no profile required to try	Steadies hosting off-hour sessions; photo-to-task for cold starts; capacity check-in before joining	No streaks; framing return as the win; capacity-based check-ins that normalize bad days as part of the pattern

Priority pain points ranked by impact on user retention and alignment to Sesh's core value proposition.

Rank	Pain Point	Journey Stage	Why It Ranks Here	Design Implication
1	Task initiation failure -- the wall of resistance before starting	Core Use	Highest frequency, highest severity. This is the core problem Sesh exists to solve. If the app does not reduce this, nothing else matters.	Photo-to-task; single-tap join; zero-setup entry into an open Sesh; presence before task clarity
2	Onboarding friction -- any required setup kills momentum before the first session	Onboarding	The population Sesh serves has the least tolerance for cognitive overhead at the point of entry. High drop-off risk before the first session is ever experienced.	One screen, one tap, one open Sesh to join -- no profile or scheduling required to try the core experience
3	Session timing mismatch -- sessions exist when users cannot use them	Core Use / Retention	Affects Adaye in Lagos, Malik on overnight shifts, and anyone not on a 9-5 schedule. Unsolved by every competitor in the market.	Community-powered Steadies create organic off-hour and global coverage as the community grows
4	Shame and inconsistency penalties -- streaks and gamification break the contract	Retention	Users with variable capacity get penalized for not showing up consistently. This causes abandonment at the exact moment they need the app most -- on hard days.	Capacity-based check-ins; no streaks; framing return as the win rather than the recovery from failure

Unit 3 prototyping priorities: Pain point 1 (task initiation) and pain point 2 (onboarding friction) are the highest-priority design problems for Unit 3. They represent the moment of maximum vulnerability and maximum abandonment risk. The two specific interactions to prototype are: (1) the single-tap join experience -- getting a user into a Sesh with zero setup; and (2) the capacity check-in interaction -- the moment before a session where the app acknowledges variable energy without penalizing it. These two interactions are where Sesh either earns trust or loses it.

SECTION 5 — MARKET OPPORTUNITIES

Three opportunities grounded in competitive gaps, journey map pain points, implicit assumption audit, and user research assumptions. Each opportunity is connected to specific survey questions that would validate or challenge it.

Opportunity	Supporting Evidence	Journey Map Connection	Survey Questions	Competitive Gap
Named community facilitators (Steadies) as trust infrastructure	No competitor has given identity to session leaders. Users across Reddit and ADHD forums create workarounds by coordinating with friends rather than trusting app-matched strangers -- confirming that named, recognizable presence reduces friction to entry.	Consideration: Will this feel awkward? Retention: recognition of recurring Steadies normalizes return and reduces the social anxiety barrier.	D1, D2, D3	Focusmate, Flow Club, Flown, Caveday -- all anonymous or staff-led only. No competitor has named community leadership.
Regulation model over performance model: presence first, task clarity second	The implicit assumptions audit confirmed that all competitors are built on a performance model (clarity, commitment, execution, tracking). Body doubling actually works as a regulation model (presence, safety, reduced friction, action). That gap is where exclusion happens.	All five stages. The performance model assumption affects how users discover, consider, onboard, use, and return to the app.	A1, A2, B3, E1, E2	Every competitor assumes task clarity exists before support is provided. Sesh assumes clarity emerges because of support.
Variable capacity design for chronic illness and executive dysfunction users beyond ADHD	Research confirms chronic illness (long COVID, fibromyalgia, ME/CFS), depression, PTSD, and caregiving responsibilities all produce documented executive dysfunction. No competitor designs for energy pacing or inconsistency as a primary user reality. Users with the strongest unmet needs are least likely to leave reviews.	Retention pain point: shame and inconsistency penalties. Core use pain point: session timing mismatch.	A3, C1, E3, E4	Tiimo addresses ADHD scheduling only. No competitor addresses energy variability, pacing, or chronic illness as a design requirement.

SECTION 6 — RESEARCH PROCESS DOCUMENTATION

AI-augmented research sprint documented across the five-phase framework: Plan, Recruit, Collect, Analyze, Synthesize and Share. Unit 2 covers Plan phase only. Primary research (Recruit through Synthesize) is scoped for Unit 3.

Phase	Tool Used	Purpose	What It Produced	Limitation Noted
Plan	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Research design	Survey structure, journey map scaffold, research assumptions, bias audit framing	AI survey questions default to attitudinal framing. All questions revised to prioritize behavioral evidence over stated preference.
Plan	Perplexity (basic)	Competitive landscape scan	Competitor features, pricing, user complaints, workaround behaviors, underserved segments, implicit design assumptions	Basic search returns results biased toward apps with strong content marketing and US-based SEO presence. Smaller or newer apps may be underrepresented.
Plan	ChatGPT	Implicit assumptions audit	Eight documented design assumptions in the body doubling market and the performance vs. regulation model reframe	AI-generated analysis reflects the volume of existing content, not the actual importance of underserved segments. Used as a lens, not a conclusion.
Plan	Primary sources (app websites, Trustpilot, Reddit, App Store)	Fact verification	Confirmed Focusmate pricing (\$8/\$12), Flow Club pricing (\$33.33/\$40), Flown and Focusmate user complaints. Flagged dubbii price as unconfirmed.	Pricing data changes frequently. All pricing verified at point of research and should be re-checked before Unit 3 prototyping.
Plan	Manual review	Bias audit	Confirmed research includes non-US users, chronic illness, overnight workers, autistic adults, and variable-capacity users as named segments	Three personas cannot represent the full range of Sesh users. Research design intentionally leaves room for discovery in primary research.
Plan	Unit 1 audited personas (Jordan, Adaeze, Malik)	Persona reference	Grounded all research assumptions in bias-audited user archetypes developed in Unit 1	Past project materials unavailable for cross-reference due to NDA obligations. Sesh personas serve as the primary reference set.

Key limitation: AI-driven market research reflects the volume and visibility of existing content, not the actual size or importance of underserved segments. Users with the strongest unmet needs -- variable capacity, chronic illness, overnight schedules, non-English markets -- are least likely to leave App Store reviews or post in productivity forums. This is a signal to invest in primary research with these populations, not a reason to deprioritize them in the product vision.

RESEARCH CONNECTION NOTES

How the survey and journey map inform each other, and which features to prototype in Unit 3.

Survey to Journey Map	Journey Map to Opportunities	Unit 3 Prototyping Priorities
Survey questions A1 and A3 directly test the task initiation and variable capacity assumptions that drive the Core Use and Retention stages. Questions C1 and C2 validate the timing mismatch pain point. Questions D1 through D3 validate the Steadies trust model. Question E2 tests whether Sesh brand voice lands correctly at the Consideration stage.	Pain point 1 (task initiation) maps to Opportunity 2 (regulation model over performance model). Pain points 3 and 4 (timing mismatch and shame penalties) map to Opportunity 1 (Steadies) and Opportunity 3 (variable capacity design). Every opportunity is grounded in at least one journey stage pain point.	Priority 1 for Unit 3 prototyping: task initiation entry point -- the single-tap join experience that gets a user into a Sesh without setup. Priority 2: the capacity check-in interaction -- the moment before a session where the app acknowledges variable energy without penalizing it. These two interactions are where Sesh either earns trust or loses it.